

Document number: P0369R0

Date: 2016-05-23

Project: Programming Language C++, WG21

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2017-07-10-15 ISO WG21 C++ Standard Meeting in Toronto (get ready to ratify and celebrate C++17)

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Intro

The 2017 summer meeting of WG21 is being hosted at the University of Toronto, in Canada on July 10-15, 2017, Monday to Saturday (inclusive).

The meeting will be held in the Bahen Centre for Information Technology at the University of Toronto (St. George Campus) in downtown Toronto.

<http://map.utoronto.ca/building/080>

https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Bahen_Centre_for_Information_Technology



Hotel

There are many hotels around the area, but none within the University campus itself.

<https://www.google.ca/maps/search/hotels+near+Bahen+Centre+for+Information+Technology,+St+George+St,+Toronto,+ON+M5S+2E4/@43.6660021,-79.4165123,14z> (<https://ibm.biz/Bd49fA>)

We are working to get discounted rates on these hotels (which hopefully include breakfast packages), but no matter which hotel you use, you will need to plan to walk 5-15 minutes to the Bahen Centre, or take a short transit ride. The major hotels within that distance are:

Holiday Inn

Hilton

Delta

Intercontinental

Marriott Eaton Centre

Park Hyatt

Sheraton Centre Hotel

We have negotiated rates that include breakfast at the Sheraton Centre Hotel of 226 CAD (plus tax) and are looking for additional hotels. As we are not hosting at a hotel, we do not anticipate a significant reduction in cost or any special deal.

Since this is located downtown, all the professional hotels are north, south, or east of the Centre towards the financial and shopping districts. The Centre is next to Chinatown, Italy town, Korea town and Portuguese town neighborhoods to the west, which offer great food; however, we do not recommend the hourly motels there.

As the meeting is held on a university campus, there is also the possibility of staying in a student residence. These have more modest amenities than hotels (for example, shared bathrooms instead of private bathrooms), some may have no AC, but also more modest prices and much closer distance, which may be particularly handy if you're attending on your own budget.

The following student residences provide short-term accommodation for members of the general public:

Knox College (3 minute walk)

Massey College (8 minute walk)

Trinity College (10 minute walk)

Victoria College (15 minute walk)

Availability of rooms may be limited; information about rates and availability will become available closer to the meeting date.

Travel and transportation

Final Jeopardy: Category: US Cities:

Answer is: Its largest airport is named for a World War II hero; its second largest, for a World War II battle.

Watson Question: What is Toronto?

Actual Question: What is Chicago?

<http://www.cs.toronto.edu/~sheila/384/w11/why-toronto.pdf>

Toronto is served by 2 nearby airports and both are named after WW heroes (though different Wars), so you can see how Watson could get confused, plus we have a baseball team in an American League. Here are the facts:

The main international airport is Pearson International Airport (YYZ). A smaller Billy Bishop Toronto City Center Island Airport (YTZ) serves local/U.S. destinations.

There is rarely any extraordinary VISA requirements for most European/US citizens to enter Canada, though you should verify.

Must read: <http://wikitravel.org/en/Toronto>

Then check against your own city to see if it reflects reality.

Getting into the city has gotten simpler and cheaper now with multiple methods. From YYZ, about 1 hour and from YTZ, about 30 minutes assuming you will end up in a hotel near the Bloor/University area (nearest subway stop is St. George or Museum Station).

If you will be in a hotel southeast of Bahen Centre, nearer to the downtown financial district, then the nearest subway stations are Queen's Park, College, St. Patrick, Dundas, Wellesley, Osgoode, and Queen; and you would add another 15 minutes from YYZ and subtract about 15 minutes from YTZ, approximately. You could certainly stay at a hotel further away as downtown Toronto is well served by a massive transportation network called the **Toronto Transit Commission** (TTC) of buses, streetcars, and subways.

1. Fastest (< 1 hour)

UP (Union Pearson) Express

This train is new and recently lowered in price though I have not personally tried it. Direct to Union or Bloor station, but you will need a subway change (separate ticket) to get to hotels in the Bloor/Yonge subway station area or the downtown financial district stations.

<https://www.upexpress.com/SchedulesStations/UpExpressRouteMap>

2. Cheapest (1-1.5 hours)

TTC (Toronto Transit Commission)

The 34 bus to Finch subway station and 192 bus to Kipling Station connects to the subway (free transfer) to your hotel destination at one of the above subway stops. Please be aware that rush hours are very difficult for transporting luggage.

3. Not the Fastest nor the Cheapest but in-between

GO Transit

You can take a GO bus with better luggage space, but it only gets you to Finch subway station or Yorkdale subway station, from which you will still have to pay and transfer to a subway line to one of the above stations near your hotel.

4. Most expensive, but most convenient

Taxis and Airport Limousines

I actually find little difference in cost between taxis (metered; assume about 50-60 CAD) and limos (fixed price by region; about 55-65 CAD) but the limos have more style and are more comfortable.

5. Shared Ride

We will enable share rides on the wiki page

6. **Car rental** (all major rental agencies are available)

Driving and parking is not recommended as is normal in any downtown metropolitan area, but actually not impossible. There will not be parking passes issued for the Centre, but street parking, and parking lots are available around Bahen Centre, though with the usual care of feeding meters. The cost of parking at any of the downtown hotel and near the Centre will be high: count on around 30-50 CAD daily.

A car is not required for the meeting.

Hotel breakfast is dependent on local hotel policy. There are numerous dining options for lunch and dinner within walking distance, including the hotel restaurants, and there will likely be a banquet requiring travel on the TTC.

A car can still be useful to get to additional restaurants or attractions (see below) outside the immediate hotel area.

Meals and refreshments

The hosts will cover all breaks but not meals. Refreshments will be served at the meeting for the mid-morning and mid-afternoon breaks.

https://www.yelp.ca/search?find_loc=University+of+Toronto,+Toronto,+Ontario&start=0&l=g:-79.36901092529297,43.67823835601339,-79.4205093383789,43.64098162513323 (<https://ibm.biz/Bd49AK>)

Attendees will be responsible for their own meals, which can be taken in the hotel restaurant or in many restaurants in walking or short-driving distance. Being a University, low cost options are abundant from food trucks, to high-end restaurants. In particular, in addition to the walking distance options, both the ethnic neighborhood to the south and west and the higher-end financial district restaurants to the north and east, taking the TTC one or two stops will gain access to culinary delights from any country. As such, it might be recommended to get some kind of week's pass to the TTC to enable you to get anywhere.

Attractions

If you are arriving early or staying after the meeting, you will find the Toronto area is full of things to see and do. In addition to the Greater Metropolitan Area, nearby are Stratford (Ontario), Niagara-on-the-Lake, Niagara Falls, Hamilton, and Ottawa.

Please see the SEE and DO sections of <http://wikitravel.org/en/Toronto>

Weather

Please see the Climate section of <http://wikitravel.org/en/Toronto>

There will be no igloos, so expect hot and muggy weather as it will be the peak of summer with many outdoor activities, and tourist events. Evenings are ideal for walking and sport activities.

Sponsoring

We still continue to look for sponsors which can through monetary contribution to ISOCPP.org, sponsor lunch, or dinner, or banquet to enable us to fund any celebration for C++17. Thank you.